PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Detection Engineer | CrowdStrike NG-SIEM | Microsoft Sentinel | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) engineer with over five years of hands-on experience in detection engineering, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations, and proactive threat hunting. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring expert-level proficiency with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and strong skill in Microsoft Sentinel, using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to write, tune, and govern detection logic at enterprise scale. At the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I build and operationalise SIEM detection rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, reduce false positive volumes through structured tuning, develop Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate incident workflows, and lead log onboarding and normalisation for new data sources. I am experienced in translating threat intelligence into actionable detections, conducting kill-chain-aligned threat hunting campaigns, and driving major incident investigations to closure. I am looking to bring this depth of detection engineering expertise to a senior SOC role where I can meaningfully strengthen an organisation's ability to detect and respond to advanced threats.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM (expert), Microsoft Sentinel (strong), KQL (Kusto Query Language), correlation rule development and tuning, false positive reduction
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework, Cyber Kill Chain, proactive threat hunting, adversary TTP (Tactics, Techniques and Procedures) analysis, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **SOAR and Automation:** SOAR playbook design and development, automated triage workflows, PowerShell scripting, API integration
- **Log Management:** Log onboarding, normalisation and pipeline management, data source integration, field-mapping validation
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Discover, Insight; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling, structured incident lifecycle management, containment and eradication
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead detection engineering on CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, developing and maintaining SIEM correlation rules, analytics pipelines, and detection logic across an enterprise environment
- Write and continuously tune KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel, systematically reducing false positive alert volumes and improving overall signal quality
- Map detection coverage to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, identifying and closing gaps across initial access, credential access, lateral movement, and exfiltration tactics
- Design and build SOAR playbooks to automate repetitive incident triage and containment actions, reducing mean time to respond on high-volume alert categories
- Lead log onboarding and normalisation for new data sources into the SIEM, validating field mappings and confirming detection fidelity before going live

- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Sentinel analytics workbooks
- Translate threat intelligence and adversary TTPs into actionable, tuned detection rules aligned to current attack patterns
- Lead investigation and containment of security incidents, following the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle from identification through post-incident review
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent policies, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) sensor deployment, and Falcon Discover asset visibility across the endpoint estate

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed Tier 2 and Tier 3 SOC alert triage and investigation across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, driving incidents to closure with clear forensic documentation
- Developed and tuned detection rules and analytic queries to reduce false positive rates and sharpen detection precision on high-risk use cases
- Supported the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to 8,000 users, improving endpoint and identity threat visibility
- Conducted threat hunting campaigns targeting identity-based attacks, credential misuse, and adversarial lateral movement
- Managed vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, prioritising findings by exploitability and asset criticality
- Automated incident and alert workflows using PowerShell scripting and Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks
- Supported onboarding of new log sources into SIEM, normalising data and validating detection coverage for each new pipeline

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and monitored security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure in a fast-paced Software as a Service (SaaS) environment
- Configured endpoint protection policies and managed security tooling to maintain continuous threat visibility
- Supported security incident triage and initial response, documenting findings and escalating to senior stakeholders where required
- Contributed to quality assurance and infrastructure hardening initiatives aligned to company risk management objectives

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed a comprehensive library of CrowdStrike NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel detection rules mapped to over 30 MITRE ATT&CK techniques, measurably closing detection coverage gaps across the kill chain
- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, delivering centralised Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and identity threat protection
- Designed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to triage for high-volume, lower-severity alerts, releasing analyst capacity for complex detection and hunting work
- Established a structured detection-tuning governance process that reduced SIEM false positive alert volumes, improving the overall health of the detection pipeline
- Supported the organisation in maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification and alignment to NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and CIS Controls

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (UK)